



THE PLAN

The twelve organisations on MamaDoc's wall

Who they are, what each is worth to you, and which ones you must not go near.

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PREPARED FOR

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In one minute

- These are MamaDoc's supporters, not yours. You have no relationship with any of them.
- The pattern is the lesson: MamaDoc built a base in one city, then added national charity names on top.
- Six are fair to approach directly. Three are MamaDoc's home turf in Leicester. Leave those alone.
- Five X More is the one to be most careful with. Never approach them as a vendor.
- Leicester City Council is the surprise. Councils buy maternity support, and faster than trusts do.

What to do

Action	Who	By when
Approach Birthrights about consent and what a woman can see about herself	You	Day 30
Ask For Baby's Sake how a record should work when the partner is the risk	You	Day 30
Read the Five X More survey reports properly before citing them anywhere	You	This week
Find how one council, not Leicester, commissions maternity support	You	Day 45
Leave the three Leicester organisations alone unless Yusuf opens the door	You	Ongoing

The twelve

National maternity charities

Who	What they are	Worth to you
Tommy's	The largest UK pregnancy and baby charity. Funds research, runs clinics	Sets what counts as evidence in maternity. A content and research route
NCT	The biggest antenatal education charity in the country	Defines what parents expect antenatal support to be. Content licensing, possibly
Birthrights	Human rights in childbirth. Published the inquiry into racism in maternity care	The most valuable name here for your specific claim. If they say your consent and records design is right, that is worth more than any testimonial
Bliss	Premature and sick babies	Only matters once the newborn module is real. Park it
MAMA Academy	Safer pregnancy charity, known for maternity notes wallets and symptom awareness	Very close to your escalation argument. Small and practical, likely to reply
For Baby's Sake	Works with both parents where there is domestic abuse	MBRRACE found 21% of the women who died had experienced domestic abuse. Ask them a question you cannot answer

Black maternal health specialists

Who	What they are	Worth to you
Five X More	The campaign that put Black maternal health into Parliament. Runs the Black Maternity Experiences survey	Enormous influence. Do not approach as a vendor. Read them, cite them accurately, be useful first
The Essential Baby Company (TEBC)	Reduces race-based inequality in maternity through training for clinicians and a patient involvement group. Commercial	Understands selling into trusts, which most charities do not. Their involvement group could be a design panel. Several similarly named entities exist at Companies House, so confirm which before contracting

Leicester, which is MamaDoc's home

Who	What they are	Worth to you
African Heritage Alliance	Runs the African Caribbean Centre after a council asset transfer	Nothing directly. Do not approach
Wesley Hall Community Centre	Community hub in Highfields, largely Black and minority ethnic. Runs antenatal and postnatal classes	Nothing directly. Do not approach
Leicester Mamas	Peer breastfeeding support since 2008. About 50 peer supporters, over 1,200 women a year	A model worth studying from a distance. Do not approach
Leicester City Council	The local authority	The interesting one. Public health and Family Hubs buy this kind of support, with real budgets, and faster than an NHS trust. Study how, then approach a different council

The rule about the Leicester four

You met Yusuf today. If you spend next week contacting the organisations whose logos sit on his website, he will hear about it, because maternity in one city is a small world. It would cost you a relationship worth more than any of those introductions.

National charities work with everyone, so they are not his to gatekeep. The Leicester organisations are his base. Leave them. If a relationship there ever makes sense, it comes through him, later, and with his knowledge.

What this wall actually teaches you

Look at the shape of it rather than the names. MamaDoc did three things in order.

- 1. Won one city first.** Four of the twelve are Leicester organisations, including the council. Depth in one place, not a thin national launch.
- 1. Borrowed credibility.** Tommy's, NCT, Birthrights and Bliss are names a hospital already trusts. A small organisation gets taken seriously by standing next to them.
- 1. Stayed specific.** Every name on that wall serves Black, Brown, migrant or vulnerable parents. Nothing is there by accident.

You have been trying to start nationally with no city, no charity names and no proof. That is harder, not more ambitious. Pick a city. It does not have to be Leicester, and it probably should not be.

How to approach a charity, if you do

Charities are asked for things constantly and offered very little. So ask a question, do not make an offer.

"I'm building maternity software and I have a problem I cannot solve from the outside. [The specific problem.] You have seen this for years and I have not. Could I have twenty minutes, or could you point me at what I should read first?"

Never ask a charity for a testimonial, a logo, or an introduction to a hospital on first contact. They protect their name carefully, and rightly.

Words explained

Word	What it means
Family Hubs	Council-run centres for families with young children, with money attached
Patient involvement group	A panel of real patients who tell you whether a design works before you build it
Asset transfer	When a council hands a building over to a community organisation to run
Peer supporter	A mother trained to support other mothers. Not a clinician, and often trusted more